

Oysters Around the World

Although most food now seems to be available virtually anywhere at any time of year, the only way to sample the finest oysters is to eat them close to their native waters. The exceptional oyster restaurants tend to be close to the best oyster beds.

NEW ZEALAND

Niagara Falls Café moderate

256 Niagara-Waikawa Rd., South Catlins;
www.niagarafallscafe.co.nz

Part roadside restaurant and part funky art gallery, the Niagara Falls Café partners Bluff oysters with flinty Central Otago Riesling or zingy Marlborough Sauvignon Blanc. Seafood aficionados should definitely follow up with the blue cod in a herb and Chardonnay sauce.

Redcliff Restaurant & Bar expensive

12 Mokonui St., Te Anau; +64 3 249 7431

A dozen Bluff oysters or house-smoked salmon at Te Anau's Redcliff Restaurant & Bar is the perfect celebration after completing Fiordland's iconic Milford Track. Redcliff's cozy bar is also the place to catch live music on summer weekends.

On The Menu

Oysters Bienville These are grilled oysters with béchamel sauce and garlic, shrimp, mushrooms, white wine, and Tabasco sauce. A New Orleans classic.

Oysters Kilpatrick An Australian and New Zealand dish that combines grilled oysters with Worcestershire sauce, diced bacon, and chopped parsley.

Oyster po' boy A traditional Louisiana "poor-boy" sandwich: a baguette filled with breaded, deep-fried oysters.

Oysters Rockefeller Created in 1899, and named after oil magnate John D. Rockefeller, these oysters are grilled with finely diced herbs, spinach, and butter.

Oyster shooter Fresh oyster served in a shot glass, often in a Bloody Mary cocktail.

TASMANIA, AUSTRALIA

Seafood from Australia's verdant island extension is venerated by mainland chefs in Sydney and Melbourne, especially oysters from Tasmania's pristine, cooler waters. Eating a freshly shucked half-dozen at the source is an essential Down Under experience.

Get Shucked inexpensive

1650 Bruny Island Main Rd., Bruny Island;
www.getshucked.com.au

Keep it simple with a splash of Tabasco and a squeeze of lemon at Get Shucked's roadside stand on rugged and robust Bruny Island. An essential complement is a zingy chili pepper (nonalcoholic) brew from the Tasmanian Chilli Beer Company.

Freycinet Marine Farm moderate

1784 Coles Bay Rd., Coles Bay;
www.freycinetmarinefarm.com

Simple wooden tables belie a sophisticated combo of oysters fresh from nearby Great Oyster Bay and the best of Tasmanian beer and wine. Improbably plump mussels and rock lobsters – from December to May only – are other tasty diversions.

Marque IV expensive

Elizabeth St. Pier, Hobart; www.marqueiv.com.au

Hobart's brilliant southern light shimmers on rows of fishing boats as Marque IV's elegant harborside dining room showcases the best Tasmanian produce. For oyster fans, the most delicious and innovative enhancements include limoncello and chili pepper or cucumber sorbet and Avrugia roe.

SYDNEY, AUSTRALIA

One of the world's great harbor cities is also a brilliant destination for fresh seafood. The oyster experience here stretches from humble market stands to stylish waterfront bars. Fine Australian wine is usually close at hand.

Sydney Fish Market inexpensive

Bank St., Pyrmont; www.sydneyfishmarket.com.au

After the fish bazaars of Japan, Sydney Fish Market offers the world's widest variety of seafood. Curious foodie travelers can seek out and sample at least ten different types of oysters, together with only-in-Australia seafood such as leather jackets, yabbies, and Moreton Bay bugs.

